the background stars. That is the position of mars today will be near a star which is east of the star near which it was yesterday. However on June 28 , we will see a change. From that date the Mars would appear to move west rather than its normal eastward motion. This reversal of direction of planets is called as 'retrograde motion'. If we continue to observe, on August 28 once again the Mars would appear to reverse the direction and again on its usual eastward motion in the celestial sphere. Usually Jupiter is brighter than Mars, however, around the period of retrograde motion the Mars was much bright than other times; even brighter than Jupiter.

Other planets also exhibited number of puzzling behaviours. Venus and Mercury always appeared very close to Sun, and hence never appeared in the midnight sky. The brightness of Jupiter also varied again when it exhibited retrograde motion. For example in 2018, Jupiter reversed its direction of motion on March 9, 2018 and again resumed its normal eastward motion on July 11, 2018.

The simple geocentric model, where planets go around the Earth could not explain why the brightness of the planets changed, and why they reversed their directions. Change in brightness and retrograde motion would be impossible if we assumed that the planets were at the same distance at all times from Earth.

To explain the puzzling phenomena astronomers in early times proposed a change in the simple geocentric model. This is called as epicycle model.

Ptolemy (2nd cent) in Greece, Aryabhatta in India and others used the epicycle model to explain the motion of the celestial objects. Their models were improved by generation of astronomers like Tycho Brahe and Neelakanta Somayaji.

Although, the model explained many phenomena there were number of mismatches. The model was becoming messy.

Arrival of telescope.

Telescope was invented by Hans Lippershey but Galilio used it for studying the sky for the first time. The telescope showed more universe was than visible to naked eye. With his simple telescope matching toy telescopes of today, Galilio was able to see mountains on the Moon, small dim stars invisible to naked eye, sunspots on the face of Sun. He was able to demonstrate that the milky way, an hazy bright patch in the sky is nothing but thousands of stars huddled together, Jupiter had moons going around it and Saturn had mysterious appendage which we now know as rings.

One of the most startling observations he made was related to telescopic observation of Venus. This convinced him to accept the theory of the Polish Astronomer Nicolus Copernicus, that it is not Sun, planets and Stars that go around Earth, but it is Earth and other planets that go around the Sun- heliocentric theory.

Heliocentric model.

Dissatisfied with the messy epicycle model Nicolus Copernicus, radically proposed that the model will become simple if we assume Sun is at the center and all planets, including Earth, go around it.

Suppose, Earth and Mars are on the two sides of the Sun, then Mars would be far and appear dim, compared to when they are on the same side. Earth orbit around Sun in 365 days, whereas Mars takes 687 days. This implies at

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